Immigration and Credit in America

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Motivation

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- Immigrants start life in the U.S. *without* a U.S. credit report
  - Any foreign credit history generally unobserved to U.S. lenders

How Do Immigrants Assimilate Into The Formal U.S. Consumer Credit System?

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- Representative anonymized sample of U.S. consumer credit reporting data, 2000 to 2024
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What We Do

- Describe **selection** of Immigrants compared to Non-Immigrants in their creditworthiness
- Describe **assimilation** in creditworthiness & access to credit over life cycle
- How **dynamics** of life cycle outcomes vary by one year difference in age of immigration, (with fixed effects for birth year & ZIP5 geography)

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- U.S. consumer credit reporting data matched with immigration data

What We Do

- Describe **selection** of Immigrants & **assimilation** dynamics over life cycle
  - Immigrants vs. same-age Non-Immigrants & Immigrants arriving at different ages

Immigrants (vs. Non-Immigrants), Immigrants Arriving At Older (vs. Younger) Ages:

- **Positive selection:** More creditworthy (once credit scored)
- Despite better creditworthiness, **lower long-term access** to auto loans & mortgages

Timing of immigration best explains our results **("history dependence")**

Our Paper Contributes To Labor Economics & Household Finance Literatures

- Prior work shows the large positive contribution of legal immigrants to U.S. economy (e.g., Azoulay et al., 2022; Bernstein et al., 2025)
- We show the **selection** of immigrants based on their credit behaviors, complementing work focusing on labor market outcomes (e.g., Borjas, 1985; Abramitzsky & Boustan, 2017)
- We show **assimilation** into the U.S. credit markets over life cycle, complementing work on labor & cultural assimilation (e.g., Borjas, 1985; Abramitzsky et al., 2014, 2020, 2021; Lubotsky, 2007; Bleakley & Chin, 2010; Doran, Geber, & Isen, 2022; Bailey et al., 2022)
- We contribute to the household finance literature that has largely not studied immigrants (e.g., Dobbie et al., 2021; Zillessen, 2022; Bakker et al., 2025; Gorback & Schubert, 2025)

Roadmap For Presentation

1. Data & Institutional Details
2. Credit Market Entry
3. Creditworthiness
4. Credit Access
5. Mechanisms

Data & Institutional Details

Data

University of Chicago Booth TransUnion Consumer Credit Panel (BTCCP)

- Anonymized data sample of 1 in 10 consumers with U.S. credit reports
- Monthly data from 2000 to 2024
- Individual tradeline data (e.g., details on each account, including opening dates) & consumer-level data (e.g., birth date, credit score, ZIP code)

Gibbs, Guttman-Kenney, Lee, Nelson, van der Klaauw & Wang
(2025, *Journal of Economic Literature*)

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American Community Survey (ACS), 2010

- Validate immigration classification

Survey of Consumer Finances (SCF), 2022

- Evaluate mechanisms

Classifying Immigrants In The BTCCP

Before 2012, U.S. Social Security Administration assigned first 5-digits of 9-digit Social Security Numbers (SSNs) sequentially within states (Puckett, 2009)

Consumers assigned SSNs as adults are very likely to be (legal) immigrants

(Klopfer & Miller, 2024; Yonker, 2017; Doran, Gelber, & Isen, 2022; Bernstein et al., 2025)

We calculate:

$$\textit{SSN Age} \; = \; \textit{SSN Year} \; - \; \textit{Birth Year}$$

"Immigrants": assigned SSN at age 21+. **"Non-Immigrants":** assigned SSN at age < 21

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Restrict To Birth Years 1975 to 1987 With SSN Ages 0 to 29:

6,122,932 consumers – 344,261 (5.6%) "Immigrants" (ACS: 6.6% includes illegal)

Follow **credit outcomes** in BTCCP for **ages 18 to 40**

- **Information frictions** may reduce immigrant credit access:
  1. Immigrants have **no credit report on arrival**
     - **Lender's prior:** Consumer with no U.S. credit report is **high credit risk**
  2. After entering the credit system, immigrants have a **shorter credit history**
     - Length of credit report has positive impact to credit scores ($\approx$15% FICO)

Institutional Details On Lending In America

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- Different cultural **tastes** & informational barriers for consumers
  - Differences in familiarity & willingness to use debt, understanding of how to build credit score

- Lenders use credit scores (+ other information) in decisions
  - Can use immigration status, can't use protected characteristics (e.g., national origin, race) under Equal Credit Opportunity Act (ECOA)

Credit Market Entry

Main Cross-Sectional Regression Specifications

β_1: average difference for Immigrants vs. Non-Immigrants from OLS regression:

$$\mathsf{Y}_i = \beta_1 \cdot \mathbb{I}\{Immigrant\}_i + \mu_{b(i)} + \eta_{g(i)} + \epsilon_i \tag{1}$$

- Includes fixed effects: birth year ($\mu_{b(i)}$) and geography based on first ZIP5 ($\eta_{g(i)}$)

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β_2: marginal difference for SSN Age one year later, from OLS regression:

$$Y_i = \beta_1 \cdot \mathbb{I}\{Immigrant\}_i + \beta_2 \cdot SSN\ Age_i + \mu_{b(i)} + \eta_{g(i)} + \epsilon_i \tag{2}$$

- Cluster standard errors by birth year

Immigrants, & Older SSN Age Immigrants, Enter Credit Market Later Than Non-Immigrants & Younger SSN Age Immigrants

	Age at First Credit Report	
	(1)	(2)
Immigrant	4.98***	1.81***
	(0.14)	(0.09)
SSN Age		0.74***
		(0.01)
F.E. Birth Year	X	X
F.E. First Zip5	X	X
R^2	0.264	0.289
Mean, SSN Age <21	19.86	19.86

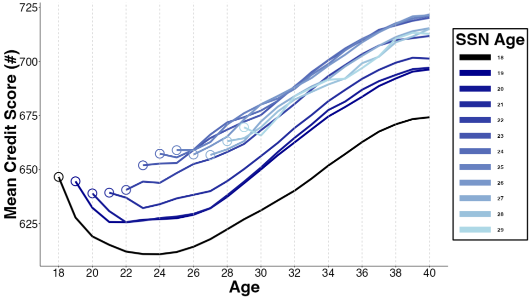
$N = 6,122,932$, *** 0.5%, ** 1%, * 5% statistical significance

Creditworthiness

Once Scored, Immigrants Have Higher Credit Scores Than Non-Immigrants

Immigrants (vs. Non-Immigrants) +27 points average scores by age 30, +33 by age 40

A. Mean Credit Score (Once Scored)



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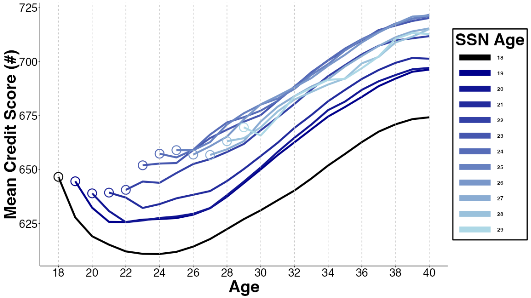
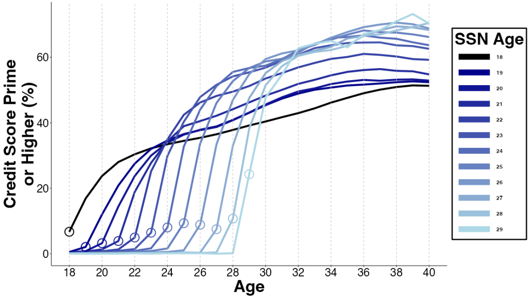


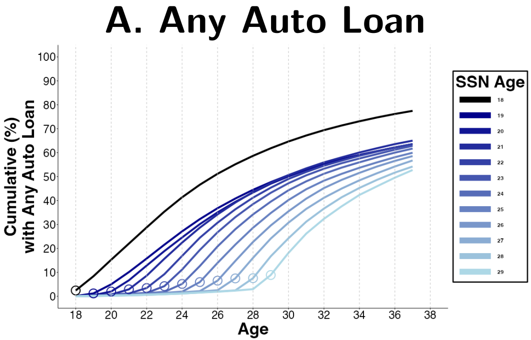
B. Prime or Higher Credit Score (660+)



↓ 5% delinquency rates conditional on credit score

Credit Access

Immigrants Persistently Less Likely To Hold Auto Loans & Mortgages



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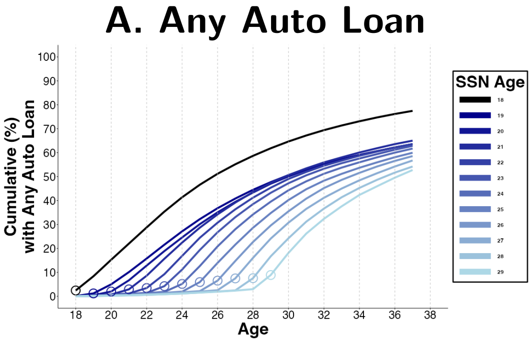

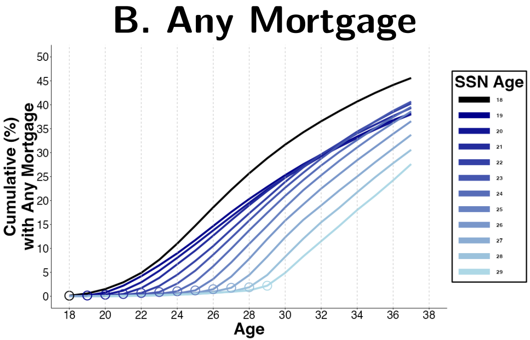

By Age 37, Immigrants 17% (16%) Less Likely To Have Auto Loan (Mortgage) - ↓ Auto Loan & Mortgage Use For Later In Life Immigrants

Dep. Var: By Age 37, has ...	Auto Loan		Mortgage		Credit Card	
	(1)	(2)	(3)	(4)	(5)	(6)
Immigrant	-12.99***	-6.87***	-7.18***	0.39	0.31	0.15
	(0.80)	(0.46)	(0.74)	(0.53)	(0.22)	(0.16)
SSN Age		-1.44***		-1.77***		0.04
		(0.10)		(0.09)		(0.03)
F.E. Birth Year	X	X	X	X	X	X
F.E. First Zip5	X	X	X	X	X	X
R^2	0.039	0.039	0.062	0.063	0.025	0.025
Mean, SSN Age <21	77.22	77.22	45.46	45.46	94.93	94.93

$N = 6,122,932$, *** 0.5%, ** 1%, * 5% statistical significance

"Paired Cohorts": Comparing Immigrants vs. One Year Younger SSN Age (Immigrants With Same Birth Year)

$$Y_{k(p),t} = \sum_{\tau=-1}^{+13} \delta_\tau \left(\mathbb{I}\{focal\ cohort\}_{k(p)} \times \mathbb{I}\{t = \tau\}\right) + \pi_{k(p)} + \nu_{p,t} + \epsilon_{k(p),t} \tag{3}$$

- 'Focal Cohort': $SSN\ Age_{c'}$ 22-30
- 'Control Cohort': $SSN\ Age_{c'} - 1$, same birth year as focal. 68 pairs (p)
- 2,176 cohort-by-year observations ($k(p), t$), s.e. clustered by birth year

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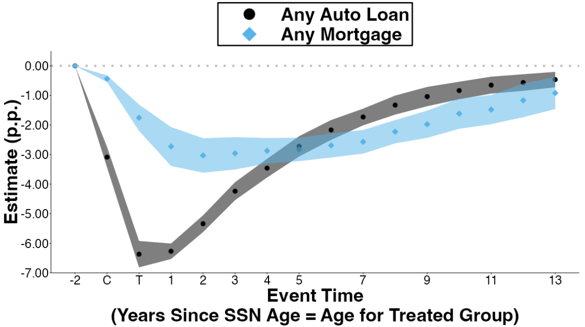
- 2,176 cohort-by-year observations ($k(p), t$), s.e. clustered by birth year
- **Results:**

  Any Auto Loan after 10 years:

  -0.46 p.p., -0.42 cumulative years

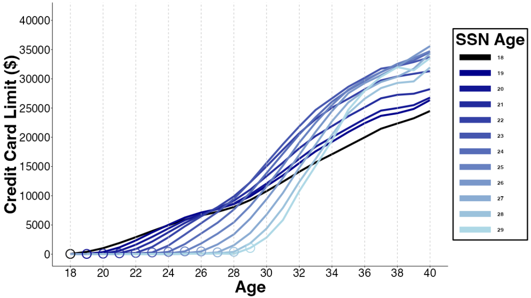
  Any Mortgage after 10 years:

  -0.92 p.p., -0.29 cumulative years



Immigrants' Credit Card Limits Are Initially Lower Than Non-Immigrants, But Become Higher Than Non-Immigrants Over Life Cycle

A. Credit Card Limits ($)



Similar patterns for number of credit cards,

credit card limit per card

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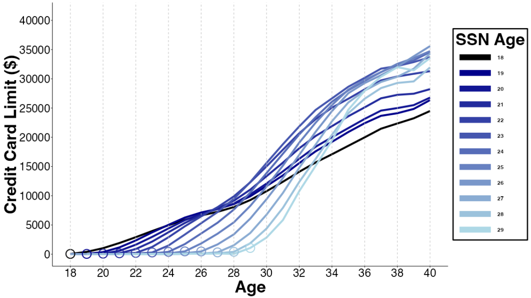

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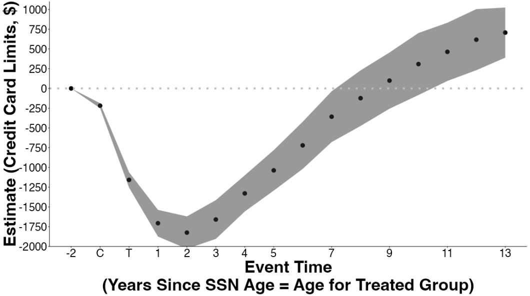


SSN Age $+2$ **Years:**

$-\$1,825$ (s.e. \$105)

SSN Age $+13$ **Years:**

$+\$707$ (s.e. \$162)

Mechanisms

What Mechanisms Explain?
- Less Credit For More Creditworthy Immigrants
- Less Credit For Later In Life Immigrants

~~Creditworthiness~~

~~Emigration~~

Credit Demand & Tastes

History Dependence

- Credit History Dependence: Financial friction...
  - no U.S. credit report
  - shorter credit history
- Non-Credit History Dependence: less time in U.S. means...
  - fewer years of U.S. earnings
  - less far along American life cycle

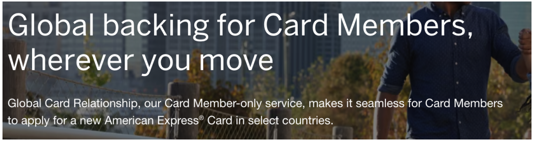
Immigrants Are 19% More Averse To Purchasing Cars With Debt (SCF, 2022)

Dep Var:	Auto Debt Attitude		Any Auto Debt		Any Auto Debt	
	(1)	(2)	(3)	(4)	(5)	(6)
Immigrant	-15.41***	-23.02***	-4.27	-0.21	-11.14	-5.10
	(4.58)	(7.25)	(5.08)	(5.01)	(8.27)	(7.87)
Immigration Age		0.98			0.88	0.63
		(0.62)			(0.76)	(0.69)
Auto Debt Attitude				26.34***		26.24***
				(3.23)		(3.24)
Demographic Controls	X	X	X	X	X	X
R^2	0.049	0.050	0.063	0.106	0.063	0.106
Mean, Immigration Age <21	79.58	79.58	47.14	47.14	47.14	47.14

$N = 1,813$, *** 0.5%, ** 1%, * 5%, $^{+}$ 10% statistical significance

Non-Portability Of Credit History Across National Boundaries May Prevent Profitable Lending. Recent Market Solutions?

American Express Global Card Relationship



Nova Credit

International credit data

Credit Passport® gives you access to foreign consumer-permissioned credit data that's translated to a local equivalent score to serve the 2 million immigrants that arrive in the United States each year and 280 million immigrants worldwide.

Equifax Canada Global Consumer Credit File

Global Consumer Credit File

Helping you grow and retain your clients who are newcomers to Canada

Global Consumer Credit File provides lenders with a seamless and secure platform that connects with global credit bureaus and enables accurate and informed decisioning through robust data.

Conclusions

How Do Immigrants Assimilate Into The Formal U.S. Consumer Credit System?

Study **selection** & **assimilation dynamics** over life cycle of Immigrants vs. Non-Immigrants
- exploit variation in age of immigration in credit data matched with immigration information

Immigrants vs. same age Non-Immigrants & Immigrants arriving at older ages:

- **Positively selected**: more creditworthy (once scored)
- Despite better creditworthiness, **lower long-term access** to auto loans & mortgages
  - Lower mortgage use explained by timing of immigration
  - Lower auto loan use also due to auto loan-specific debt aversion
- *Timing* of immigration best explains our results ("**history dependence**")

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Thank You!

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Sample In BTCCP

Sample Restrictions

- Birth years 1975 - 1987
- SSN Ages 0 to 29 (21 to 29 "Immigrants")
- Credit report by 2011

Entrant Sample

6,122,932 consumers

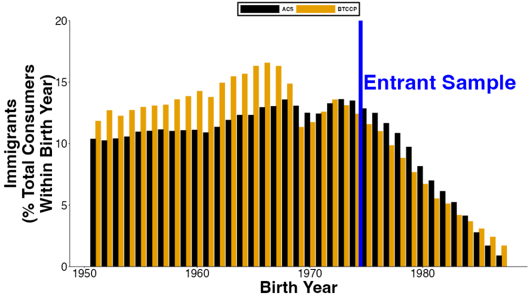
– 344,261 (5.6%) "Immigrants" (ACS: 6.6% includes illegal)

Follow **credit outcomes** in BTCCP for **ages 18 to 40**

Immigrant Classification Aligns With American Community Survey (ACS)

Distribution of Immigrants by...

A. Birth Year



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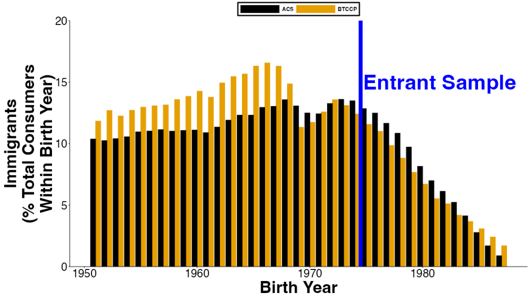
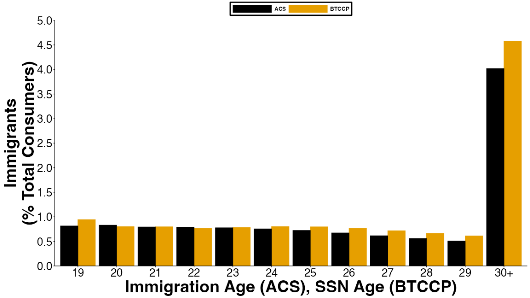


B. Immigration Age



BTCCP: 11.27% SSN Age 21+

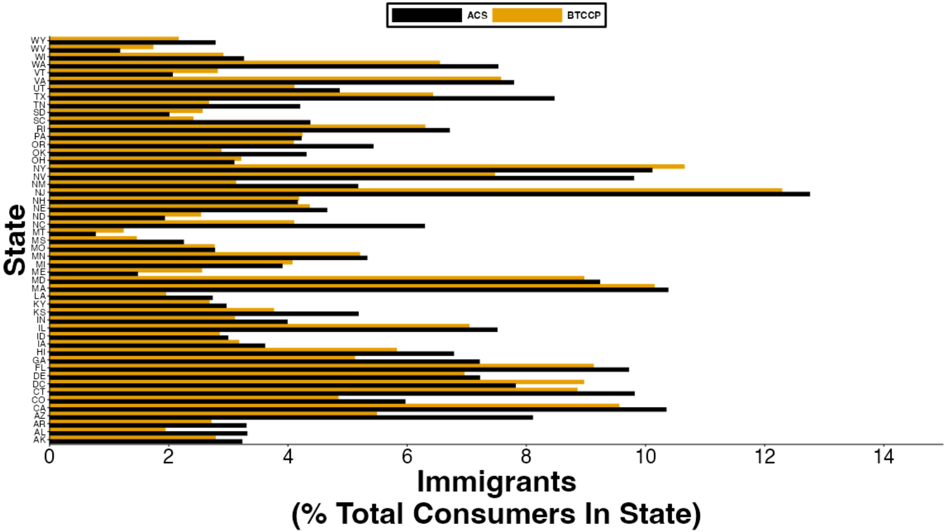
ACS: 10.2% Immigrated at Age 21+

Distribution of immigrants aligns by geography. Immigrants more mobile than non-immigrants.

"Entrant Sample": Restrict To Birth Years 1975 - 1987 To Observe U.S. Entry At Ages 21 To 29 & Credit Outcomes For Ages 18 To 40

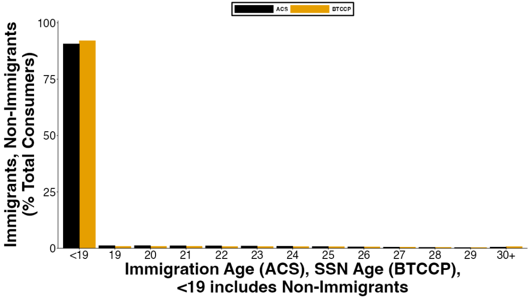
TransUnion Consumers	
... born 1951 to 2004	31,869,445
... with a SSN in TransUnion	25,237,917
Clean Sample	18,572,654
... SSN Age <21	16,478,940
... SSN Age 21+	2,093,714 (11.27%)
... Immigrant Cohorts (Birth Year x SSN Year)	775
Entrant Sample (SSN Age < 30)	6,122,932
... SSN Age < 21	5,778,671
... SSN Age 21-29	344,261 (5.62%)
... Immigrant Cohorts (Birth Year x SSN Year)	102

Geographic Comparison of Immigrants: ACS vs. BTCCP



Immigrant Classification in Entrants Sample: ACS vs. BTCCP

A. Non-Immigrants and Immigrants by Immigration Age



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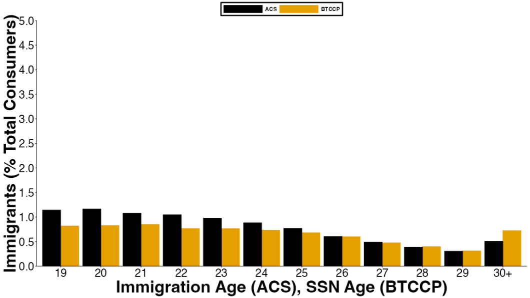
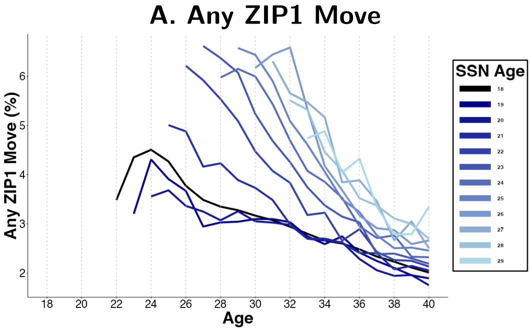
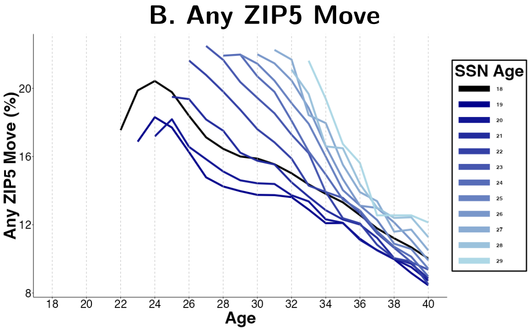


BTCCP: 5.62% SSN Age 21 to 29

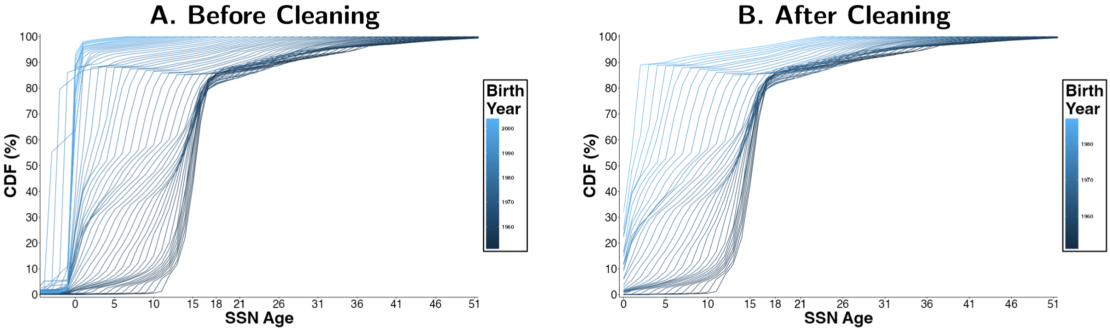
ACS: 6.57% Immigrated at Age 21 to 29

Geographic Mobility





SSN Ages By Birth Year



Consumers By SSN Age

SSN Age	Clean Sample	Entrant Sample
$<$19	16,155,157	5,677,001
19	175,194	50,475
20	148,589	51,195
21	148,019	52,450
22	141,492	47,302
23	145,218	47,214
24	149,000	45,314
25	147,899	42,005
26	142,319	36,976
27	133,147	29,383
28	123,338	24,415
29	113,435	19,202
30+	849,847	44,642

Sample Frame and Timing of SSN Assignment

Calendar year	Birth year 1975	1976	1977	1978	1979	1980	1981	1982	1983	1984	1985	1986	1987
1993	≤18												
1994	19	≤18											
1995	20	19	≤18										
1996	21	20	19	≤18									
1997	22	21	20	19	≤18								
1998	23	22	21	20	19	≤18							
1999	24	23	22	21	20	19	≤18						
2000	25	24	23	22	21	20	19	≤18					
2001	26	25	24	23	22	21	20	19	≤18				
2002	27	26	25	24	23	22	21	20	19	≤18			
2003	28	27	26	25	24	23	22	21	20	19	≤18		
2004	29	28	27	26	25	24	23	22	21	20	19	≤18	
2005	30	29	28	27	26	25	24	23	22	21	20	19	≤18
2006	31	30	29	28	27	26	25	24	23	22	21	20	19
2007	32	31	30	29	28	27	26	25	24	23	22	21	20
2008	33	32	31	30	29	28	27	26	25	24	23	22	21
2009	34	33	32	31	30	29	28	27	26	25	24	23	22
2010	35	34	33	32	31	30	29	28	27	26	25	24	23
2011	36	35	34	33	32	31	30	29	28	27	26	25	24
2012	37	36	35	34	33	32	31	30	29	28	27	26	25
2013	38	37	36	35	34	33	32	31	30	29	28	27	26
2014	39	38	37	36	35	34	33	32	31	30	29	28	27
2015	40	39	38	37	36	35	34	33	32	31	30	29	28
2016	41	40	39	38	37	36	35	34	33	32	31	30	29
2017	42	41	40	39	38	37	36	35	34	33	32	31	30
2018	43	42	41	40	39	38	37	36	35	34	33	32	31
2019	44	43	42	41	40	39	38	37	36	35	34	33	32
2020	45	44	43	42	41	40	39	38	37	36	35	34	33
2021	46	45	44	43	42	41	40	39	38	37	36	35	34
2022	47	46	45	44	43	42	41	40	39	38	37	36	35
2023	48	47	46	45	44	43	42	41	40	39	38	37	36
2024	49	48	47	46	45	44	43	42	41	40	39	38	37

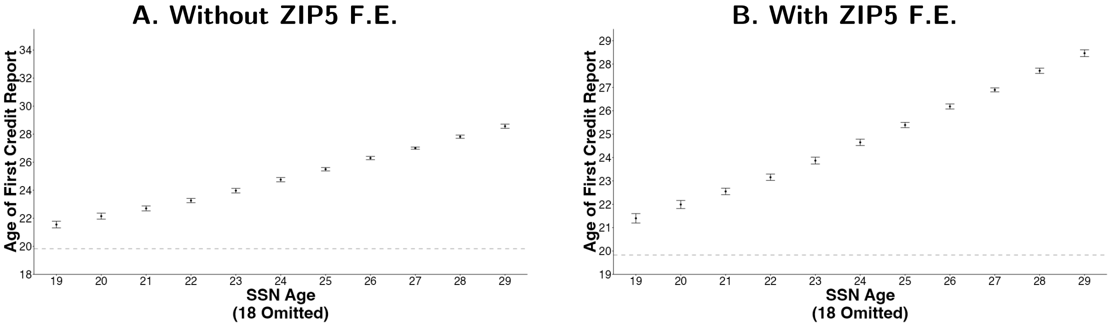
Age at SSN assignment

Years of data in our sample

Summary Statistics

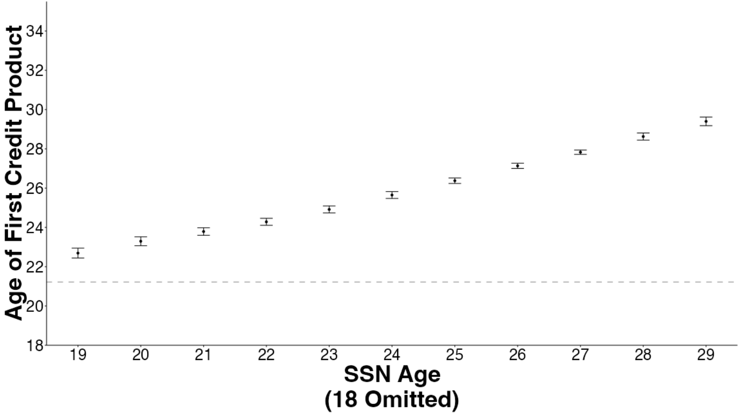
	Non-Immigrants *(SSN Age ¡ 21)*		Immigrants *(SSN Age 21 to 29)*	
	Mean	*N*	Mean	*N*
Credit Report				
Age at First Credit Report	19.86	5,778,671	25.21	344,261
Credit Score				
Any Score by Age 30 (%)	97.57	5,778,671	88.14	344,261
Credit Score at Age 30	626.1	5,461,785	660.7	293,349
Any Score by Age 40 (%)	99.68	4,487,804	99.14	312,391
Credit Score at Age 40	659.5	4,179,752	698.9	270,177
Auto Loan				
Any Auto Loan (%)	79.97	5,778,671	66.07	344,261
Age at First Auto Loan	27.62	4,621,146	31.61	227,439
Mortgage				
Any Mortgage (%)	50.06	5,778,671	46.41	344,261
Age at First Mortgage	30.59	2,892,536	33.79	159,758
Credit Card				
Any Credit Card (%)	94.51	5,778,671	94.00	344,261
Age at First Credit Card	24.42	5,461,356	27.97	323,607
Credit Card Limits at Age 30	$11,733	5,778,671	$11,193	344,261
Credit Card Limits at Age 40	$22,477	4,487,804	$28,158	312,391

Age At First Credit Report

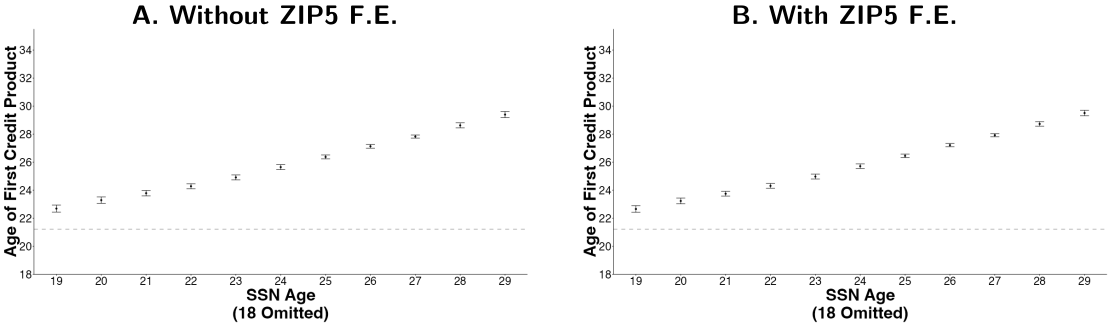


SSN Assigned At Older Age → Later Entry Into U.S. Credit System

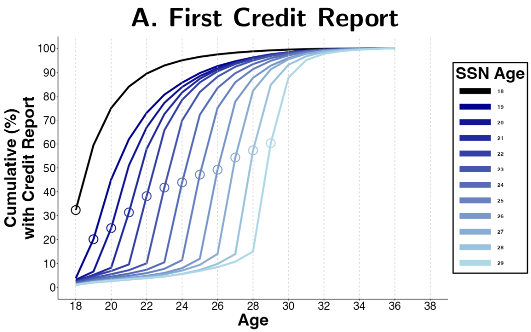
$$Y_i = \phi_{SSN\ Age(i)} + \mu_{b(i)} + \epsilon_i \quad (1)$$

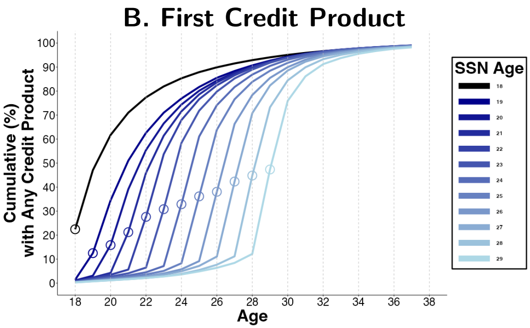


Age At First Credit Product



Age At First Credit Report and First Credit Product By SSN Age Cohort





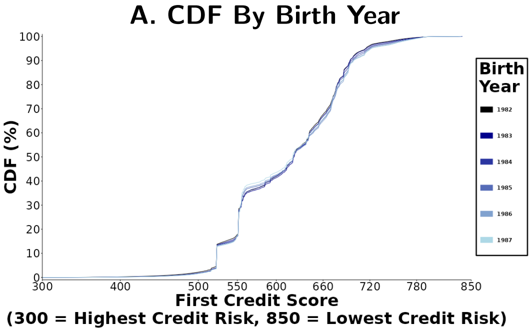
Credit Entry

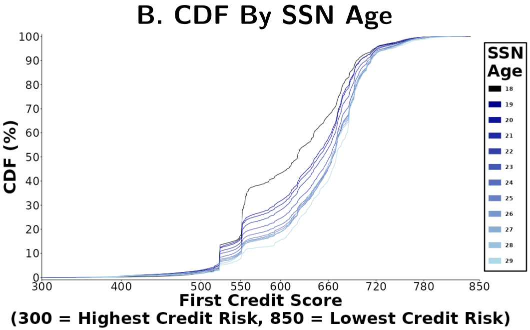
Dep Var: Age at First...	Credit Report		Credit Product	
	(1)	(2)	(3)	(4)
Immigrant	4.979***	1.808***	4.686***	1.618***
	(0.143)	(0.088)	(0.149)	(0.106)
SSN Age		0.744***		0.720***
		(0.014)		(0.016)
F.E. Birth Year	X	X	X	X
F.E. First Zip5	X	X	X	X
R^2	0.264	0.289	0.120	0.129
N	6,122,932	6,122,932	6,122,932	6,122,932
Mean, SSN Age ¡21	19.864	19.864	21.251	21.251

Credit Entry With Additional F.E.

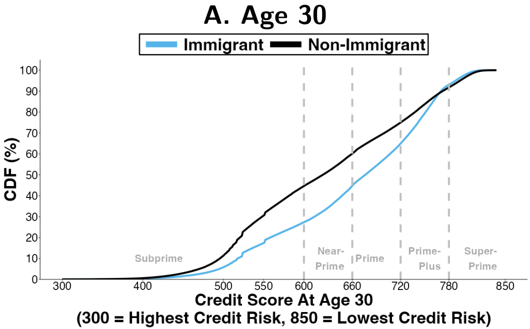
Dep Var: Age at First...	Credit Report		Credit Product		Auto Loan		Mortgage		Credit Card	
	(1)	(2)	(3)	(4)	(5)	(6)	(7)	(8)	(9)	(10)
Immigrant	4.782***	1.691***	4.403***	1.477***	3.719***	1.424***	1.642***	-0.082	3.929***	1.195***
	(0.117)	(0.073)	(0.116)	(0.088)	(0.206)	(0.136)	(0.101)	(0.052)	(0.146)	(0.125)
SSN Age		0.727***		0.689***		0.540***		0.406***		0.644***
		(0.014)		(0.016)		(0.023)		(0.017)		(0.019)
F.E. Birth Year	X	X	X	X	X	X	X	X	X	X
F.E. First Zip5	X	X	X	X	X	X	X	X	X	X
F.E. Last Zip5	X	X	X	X	X	X	X	X	X	X
F.E. Longest Zip5	X	X	X	X	X	X	X	X	X	X
F.E. Number Zip5	X	X	X	X	X	X	X	X	X	X
R^2	0.299	0.323	0.184	0.192	0.168	0.169	0.153	0.154	0.155	0.159
N	6,122,932	6,122,932	6,122,932	6,122,932	6,122,932	6,122,932	6,122,932	6,122,932	6,122,932	6,122,932
Mean, SSN Age ¡21	19.864	19.864	21.251	21.251	29.151	29.151	36.356	36.356	22.677	22.677

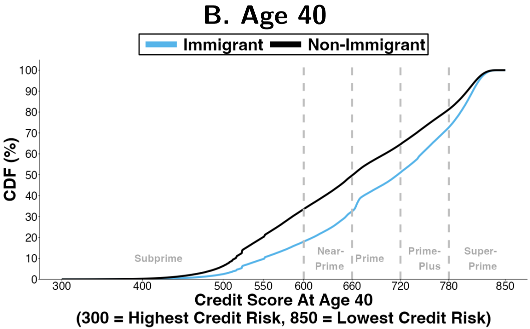
CDF Of First Credit Score



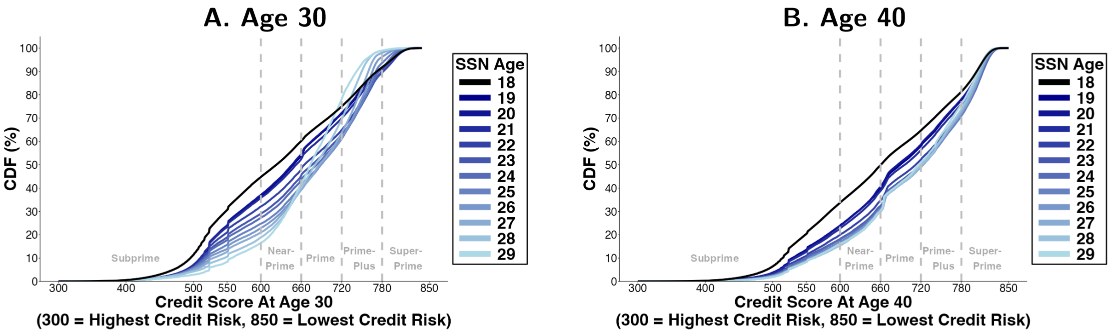


CDF Of Credit Score At Ages 30 & 40, By Immigration Status

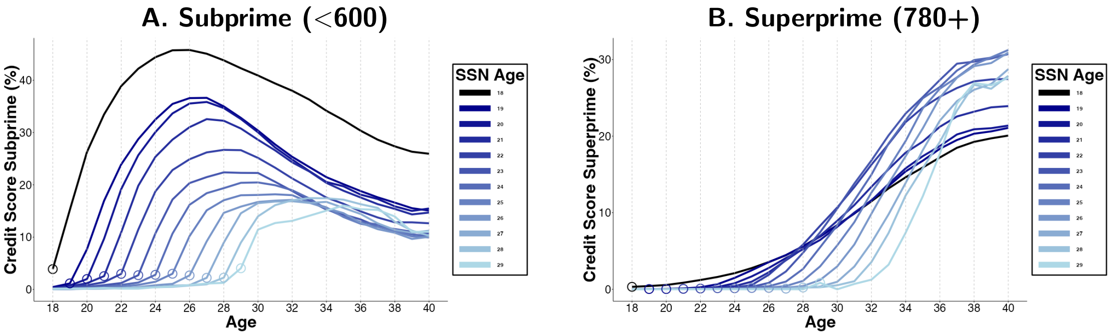




CDF Of Credit Score At Ages 30 & 40, By SSN Age



Lifecycle Of The Distribution Of Credit Scores By SSN Age Cohorts



Immigrant Credit Scores Higher In Spite Of Shorter Credit Histories

	Credit Score at		Any Prime or Higher (660+) Credit Score at	
	Age 30	Age 40	Age 30	Age 40
	(1)	(2)	(3)	(4)
Immigrant	15.7***	21.6***	6.6***	2.0***
	(1.2)	(0.6)	(0.6)	(0.2)
SSN Age	1.6***	1.5***	-0.1	1.6***
	(0.3)	(0.2)	(0.2)	(0.1)
F.E. Birth Year	X	X	X	X
F.E. First Zip5	X	X	X	X
R^2	0.202	0.200	0.156	0.152
N	5,755,134	4,449,929	6,122,932	4,800,195
Mean, SSN Age <21	626.1	659.5	37.71	46.84

Credit Scores At Ages 30 & 40,

Dep Var: Credit Score at ...	Age 30		Age 40	
	(1)	(2)	(3)	(4)
Immigrant	27.1***	18.8***	32.7***	25.8***
	(1.1)	(1.6)	(1.0)	(0.7)
SSN Age		2.0***		1.5***
		(0.4)		(0.2)
F.E. Birth Year	X	X	X	X
F.E. First Zip5	X	X	X	X
R^2	0.135	0.135	0.132	0.132
N	5,755,134	5,755,134	4,449,929	4,449,929
Mean, SSN Age ¡21	626.1	626.1	659.5	659.5

Credit Scores At Ages 30 & 40, With Additional F.E.

	Credit Score At...				Probability of Prime or Higher Score At...			
	Age 30		Age 40		Age 30		Age 40	
	(1)	(2)	(3)	(4)	(5)	(6)	(7)	(8)
Immigrant	22.27***	15.69***	28.14***	21.56***	5.99***	6.60***	8.97***	1.99***
	(1.03)	(1.24)	(0.94)	(0.64)	(0.92)	(0.57)	(0.27)	(0.21)
SSN Age		1.61***		1.46***		-0.14		1.58***
		(0.31)		(0.16)		(0.19)		(0.09)
F.E. Birth Year	X	X	X	X	X	X	X	X
F.E. First Zip5	X	X	X	X	X	X	X	X
F.E. Last Zip5	X	X	X	X	X	X	X	X
F.E. Longest Zip5	X	X	X	X	X	X	X	X
F.E. Number Zip5	X	X	X	X	X	X	X	X
R^2	0.202	0.202	0.200	0.200	0.156	0.156	0.151	0.152
N	5,755,134	5,755,134	4,449,929	4,449,929	6,122,932	6,122,932	4,800,195	4,800,195
Mean, SSN Age ¡21	626.10	626.10	659.52	659.52	37.71	37.71	46.84	46.84

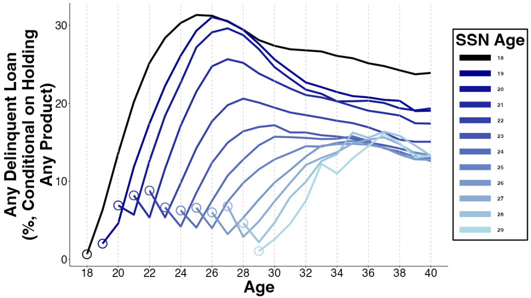
Credit Score Prime or Higher (660+) At Ages 30 & 40,

Dep Var: Prime or Higher at ...	Age 30		Age 40	
	(1)	(2)	(3)	(4)
Immigrant	7.30***	7.63***	9.00***	2.01***
	(1.02)	(0.74)	(0.20)	(0.14)
SSN Age		-0.08		1.58***
		(0.20)		(0.09)
F.E. Birth Year	X	X	X	X
F.E. First Zip5	X	X	X	X
R^2	0.104	0.104	0.092	0.092
N	6,122,932	6,122,932	4,800,195	4,800,195
Mean, SSN Age ¡21	37.71	37.71	46.84	46.84

Credit Score Prime or Higher (660+) At Ages 30 & 40, With Additional F.E.

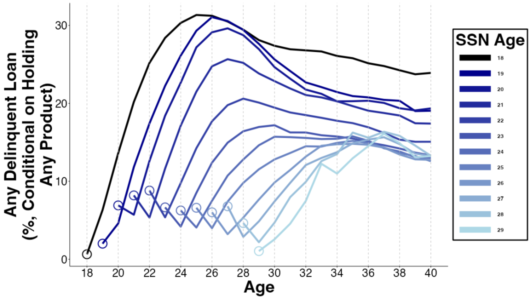
Immigrants (vs. Non-Immigrants) Have More Creditworthy Behaviors: Lower Delinquency Rates & Lower Credit Card Utilization

A. Any Delinquency

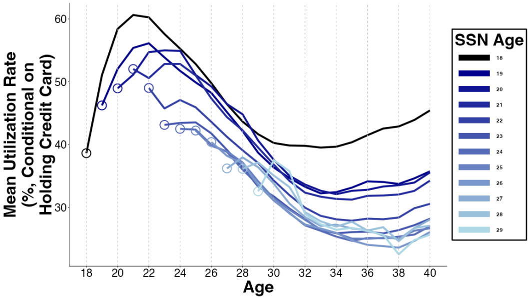


Immigrants (vs. Non-Immigrants) Have More Creditworthy Behaviors: Lower Delinquency Rates & Lower Credit Card Utilization

A. Any Delinquency

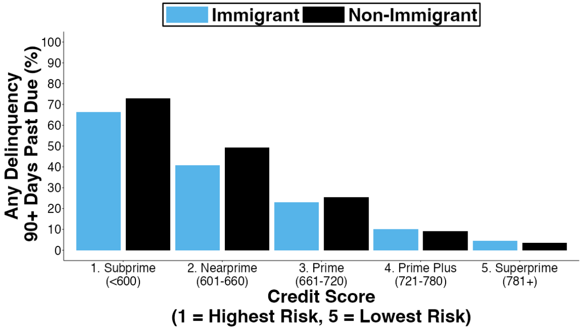


B. Credit Card Utilization Rate

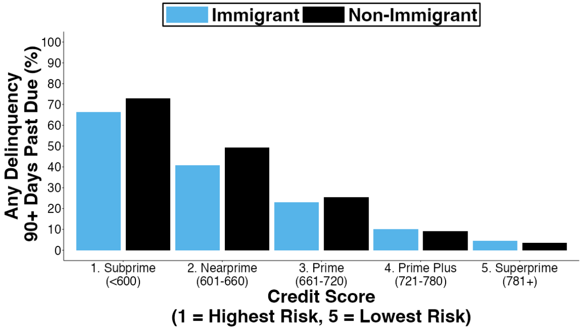


↓ 5% delinquency rates at age 37 conditional on credit score at age 30

Immigrants (vs. Non-Immigrants) Are More Creditworthy: 5% Lower Delinquency Rates At Age 37 Conditional On Age 30 Credit Score



Immigrants (vs. Non-Immigrants) Are More Creditworthy: 5% Lower Delinquency Rates At Age 37 Conditional On Age 30 Credit Score

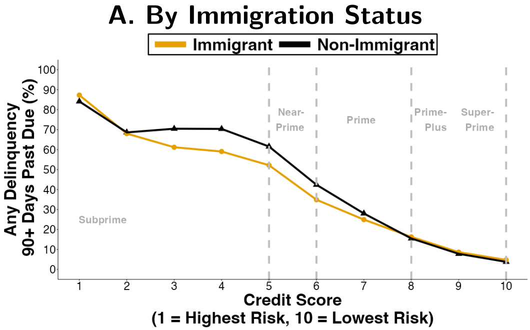


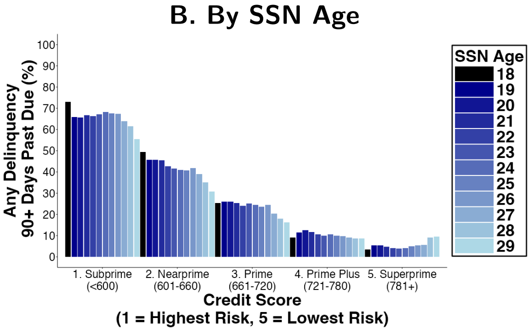
Immigrant	-0.0140***
	(0.0041)
SSN Age	-0.0004
	(0.0005)
F.E. Birth Year	X
F.E. Age 30 Zip5	X
F.E. Age 30 Credit Score	X
R^2	0.185
N	5,755,134
Mean, SSN Age <21	0.2722

Calibration Bias: Delinquency At 37 Conditional On Age 30 Credit Score

Dep Var: Any delinquency by age 37	All		Subprime		Nearprime		Prime		Prime Plus		Superprime	
	(1)	(2)	(3)	(4)	(5)	(6)	(7)	(8)	(9)	(10)	(11)	(12)
Immigrant	-1.58***	-1.40***	-2.85***	-3.69***	-3.53***	-2.72***	-1.49***	0.06	0.08	0.99***	0.28	0.37
	(0.24)	(0.41)	(0.40)	(0.74)	(0.36)	(0.58)	(0.24)	(0.49)	(0.10)	(0.19)	(0.14)	(0.28)
SSN Age		-0.04		0.23		-0.19		-0.34***		-0.21***		-0.03
		(0.05)		(0.12)		(0.09)		(0.07)		(0.03)		(0.07)
F.E. Birth Year	X	X	X	X	X	X	X	X	X	X	X	X
F.E. Age 30 Zip5	X	X	X	X	X	X	X	X	X	X	X	X
F.E. Age 30 Credit Score	X	X	X	X	X	X	X	X	X	X	X	X
R^2	0.185	0.185	0.032	0.032	0.028	0.028	0.027	0.027	0.025	0.025	0.022	0.022
N	5,755,134	5,755,134	2,515,933	2,515,933	898,118	898,118	871,578	871,578	999,130	999,130	999,130	470,375
Mean, SSN Age ¡21	27.22	27.22	45.53	45.53	26.20	26.20	13.14	13.14	4.51	4.51	1.63	1.63

Any Delinquency By Age 37, Conditional On Age 30 Credit Score

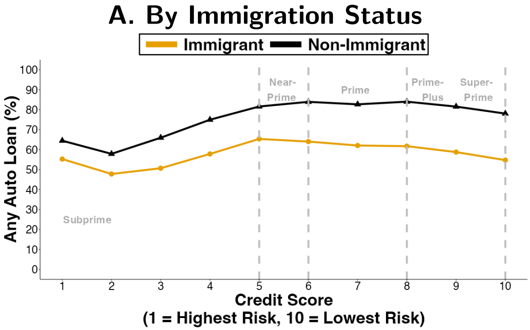


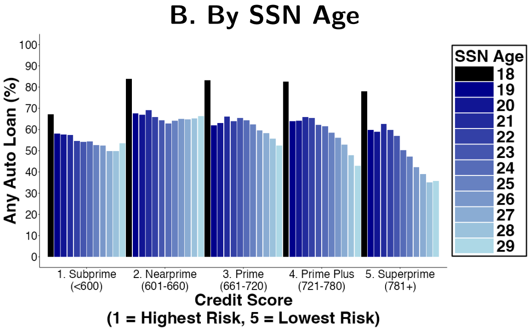


Age 37 Credit Outcomes Conditional On Age 30 Credit Score

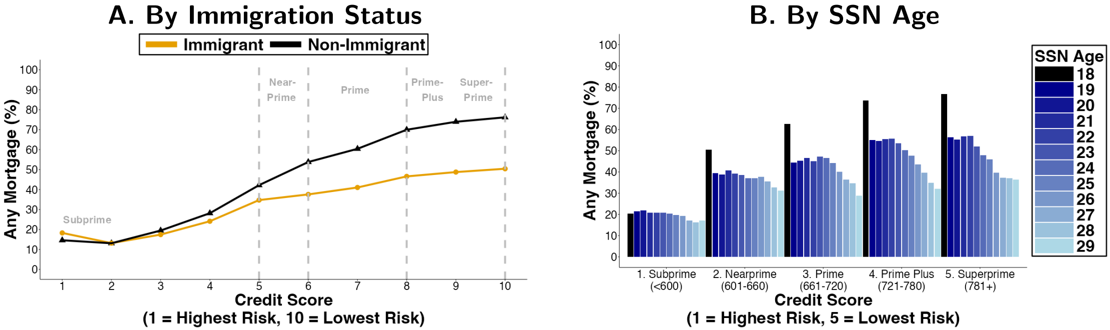
Dep Var: Outcomes at Age 37...	Any Auto Loan		Any Mortgage		Any Credit Card		Number of Credit Cards		Credit Card Limits	
	(1)	(2)	(3)	(4)	(5)	(6)	(7)	(8)	(9)	(10)
Immigrant	-14.68***	-8.89***	-1.42***	-1.61***	-11.93***	-2.33***	0.40***	0.22***	-795.8	981.1
	(0.49)	(0.39)	(0.06)	(0.13)	(0.49)	(0.50)	(0.04)	(0.03)	(565.0)	(561.8)
SSN Age		-1.42***		0.05		-2.35***		0.04***		-434.6**
		(0.06)		(0.03)		(0.12)		(0.01)		(131.7)
F.E. Birth Year	X	X	X	X	X	X	X	X	X	X
F.E. Age 30 Zip5	X	X	X	X	X	X	X	X	X	X
F.E. Age 30 Credit Score	X	X	X	X	X	X	X	X	X	X
R^2	0.107	0.108	0.268	0.268	0.110	0.110	0.142	0.142	0.306	0.306
N	5,755,134	5,755,134	5,755,134	5,755,134	5,755,134	5,755,134	5,755,134	5,755,134	5,755,134	5,755,134
Mean, SSN Age ¡21	75.34	75.34	44.73	44.73	92.21	92.21	3.92	3.92	$20,515.6	$20,515.6

Any Auto Loan By Age 37, Conditional On Age 30 Credit Score

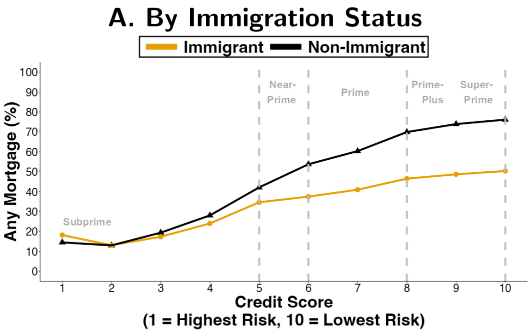


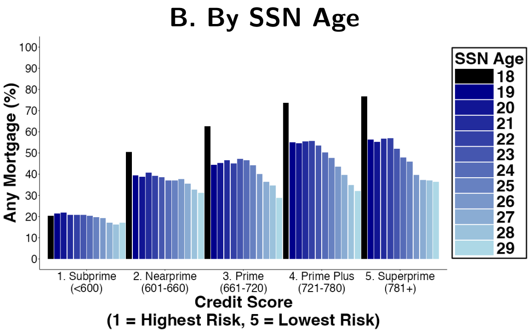


Any Mortgage By Age 37, Conditional On Age 30 Credit Score



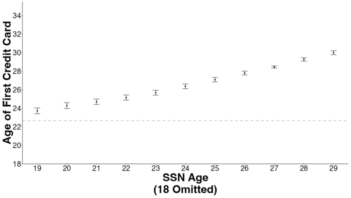
Any Mortgage By Age 37, Conditional On Age 30 Credit Score



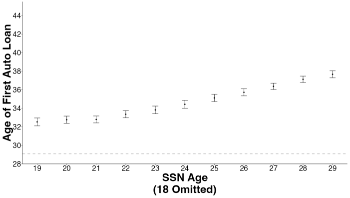


Age At First Credit Product By Type

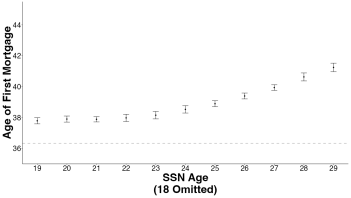
A. Credit Card



B. Auto Loan



C. Mortgage



Credit Access

Dep Var: Age at First...	Auto Loan		Mortgage		Credit Card	
	(1)	(2)	(3)	(4)	(5)	(6)
Immigrant	4.604***	1.967***	2.058***	0.219*	4.309***	1.367***
	(0.274)	(0.217)	(0.151)	(0.083)	(0.184)	(0.158)
SSN Age		0.619***		0.432***		0.690***
		(0.024)		(0.018)		(0.020)
F.E. Birth Year	X	X	X	X	X	X
F.E. First Zip5	X	X	X	X	X	X
R^2	0.080	0.082	0.080	0.081	0.080	0.085
N	6,122,932	6,122,932	6,122,932	6,122,932	6,122,932	6,122,932
Mean, SSN Age ¡21	29.151	29.151	36.356	36.356	22.677	22.677

Credit Access With Additional F.E.

Dep Var: Age at First...	Credit Report		Credit Product		Auto Loan		Mortgage		Credit Card	
	(1)	(2)	(3)	(4)	(5)	(6)	(7)	(8)	(9)	(10)
Immigrant	4.782***	1.691***	4.403***	1.477***	3.719***	1.424***	1.642***	-0.082	3.929***	1.195***
	(0.117)	(0.073)	(0.116)	(0.088)	(0.206)	(0.136)	(0.101)	(0.052)	(0.146)	(0.125)
SSN Age		0.727***		0.689***		0.540***		0.406***		0.644***
		(0.014)		(0.016)		(0.023)		(0.017)		(0.019)
F.E. Birth Year	X	X	X	X	X	X	X	X	X	X
F.E. First Zip5	X	X	X	X	X	X	X	X	X	X
F.E. Last Zip5	X	X	X	X	X	X	X	X	X	X
F.E. Longest Zip5	X	X	X	X	X	X	X	X	X	X
F.E. Number Zip5	X	X	X	X	X	X	X	X	X	X
R^2	0.299	0.323	0.184	0.192	0.168	0.169	0.153	0.154	0.155	0.159
N	6,122,932	6,122,932	6,122,932	6,122,932	6,122,932	6,122,932	6,122,932	6,122,932	6,122,932	6,122,932
Mean, SSN Age ¡21	19.864	19.864	21.251	21.251	29.151	29.151	36.356	36.356	22.677	22.677

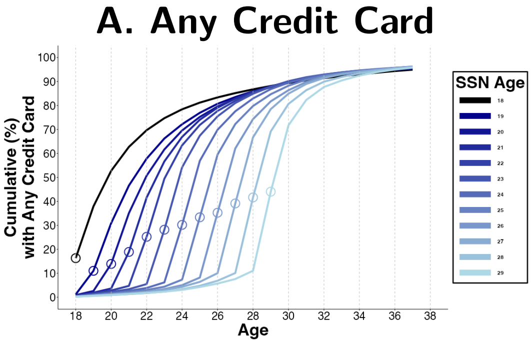
Credit Access By Age 37

Dep. Var: By Age 37, has ...	Auto Loan		Mortgage		Credit Card	
	(1)	(2)	(3)	(4)	(5)	(6)
Immigrant	-12.99***	-6.87***	-7.18***	0.39	0.31	0.15
	(0.80)	(0.46)	(0.74)	(0.53)	(0.22)	(0.16)
SSN Age		-1.44***		-1.77***		0.04
		(0.10)		(0.09)		(0.03)
F.E. Birth Year	X	X	X	X	X	X
F.E. First Zip5	X	X	X	X	X	X
R^2	0.039	0.039	0.062	0.063	0.025	0.025
N	6,122,932	6,122,932	6,122,932	6,122,932	6,122,932	6,122,932
Mean, SSN Age ¡21	77.22	77.22	45.46	45.46	94.93	94.93

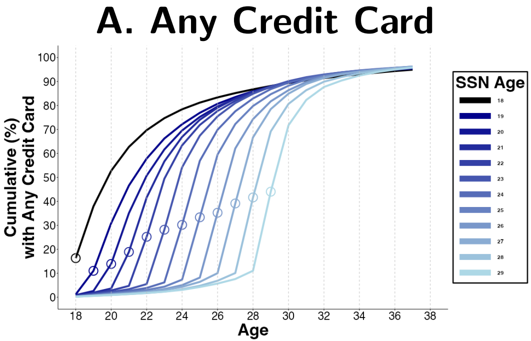
Credit Access By Age 37 With Additional F.E.

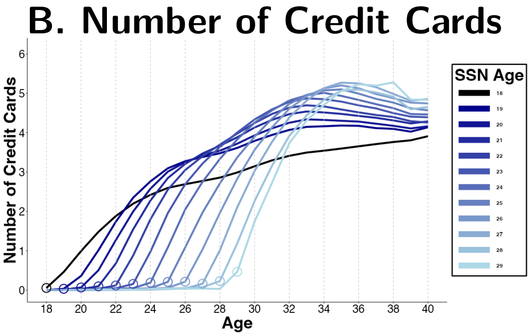
Dep Var: By Age 37, has...	Auto Loan		Mortgage		Credit Card	
	(1)	(2)	(3)	(4)	(5)	(6)
Immigrant	-8.94***	-4.43***	-4.30***	2.33***	1.14***	0.50***
	(0.67)	(0.20)	(0.67)	(0.35)	(0.22)	(0.14)
SSN Age		-1.06***		-1.56***		0.15***
		(0.11)		(0.09)		(0.04)
F.E. Birth Year	X	X	X	X	X	X
F.E. First Zip5	X	X	X	X	X	X
F.E. Last Zip5	X	X	X	X	X	X
F.E. Longest Zip5	X	X	X	X	X	X
F.E. Number Zip5	X	X	X	X	X	X
R^2	0.124	0.124	0.146	0.146	0.060	0.060
N	6,122,932	6,122,932	6,122,932	6,122,932	6,122,932	6,122,932
Mean, SSN Age ¡21	77.22	77.22	45.46	45.46	94.93	94.93

Immigrants’ Access to Credit Cards Converges With Non-Immigrants

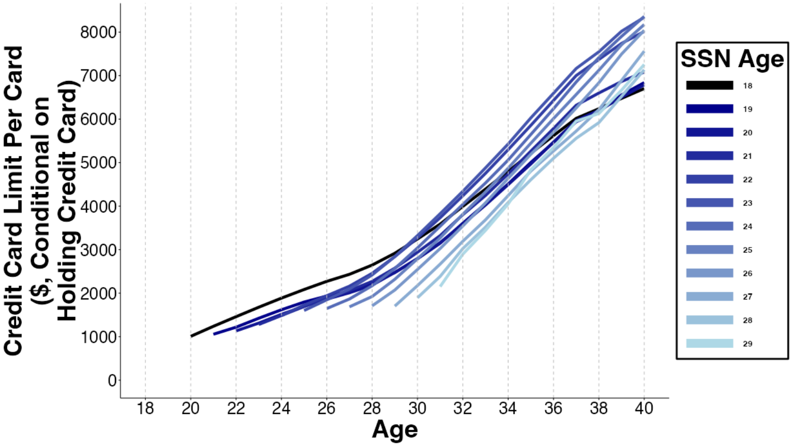


Immigrants' Access to Credit Cards Converges With Non-Immigrants



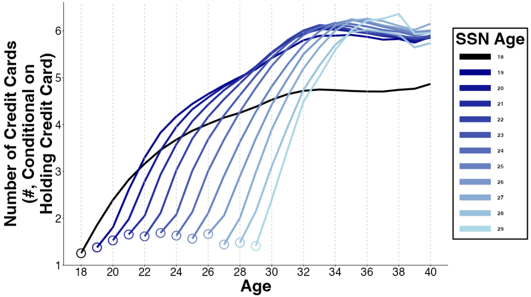


Credit Card Limit Per Card



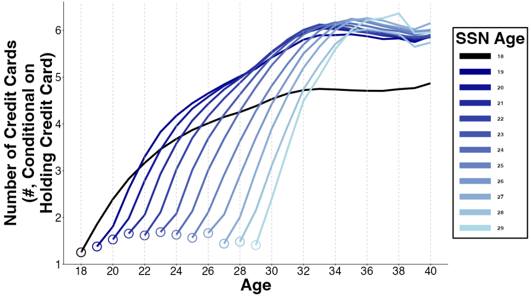
Immigrants' Credit Card Access, Conditional On Holding Any Credit Card

A. Number of Credit Cards

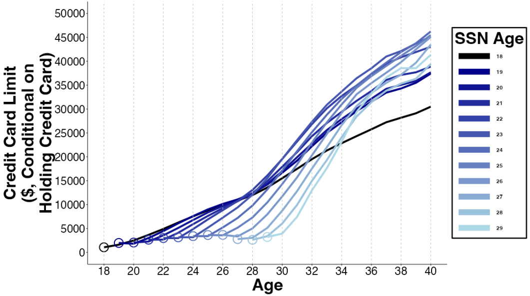


Immigrants' Credit Card Access, Conditional On Holding Any Credit Card

A. Number of Credit Cards



B. Credit Card Limits



Number of Credit Cards At Age 30

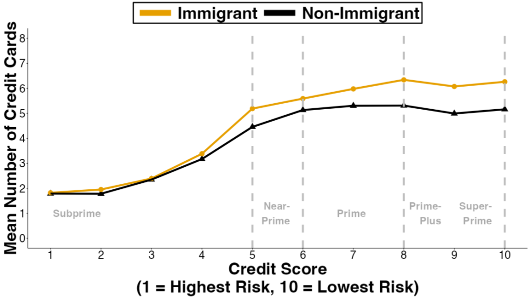
Number of Credit Cards At Age 40

Credit Card Limits At Age 30

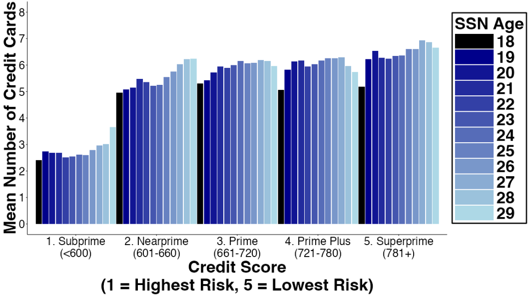
Credit Card Limits At Age 40

Number Of Credit Cards At Age 37, Conditional On Age 30 Credit Score

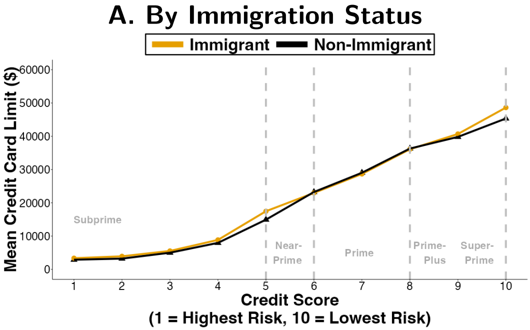
A. By Immigration Status

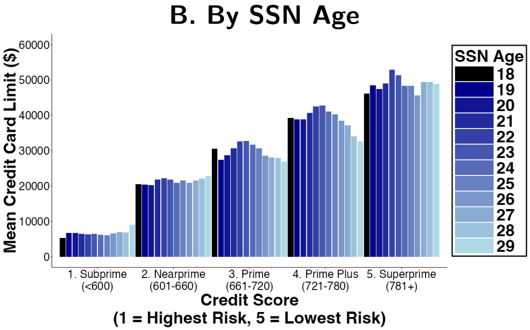


B. By SSN Age

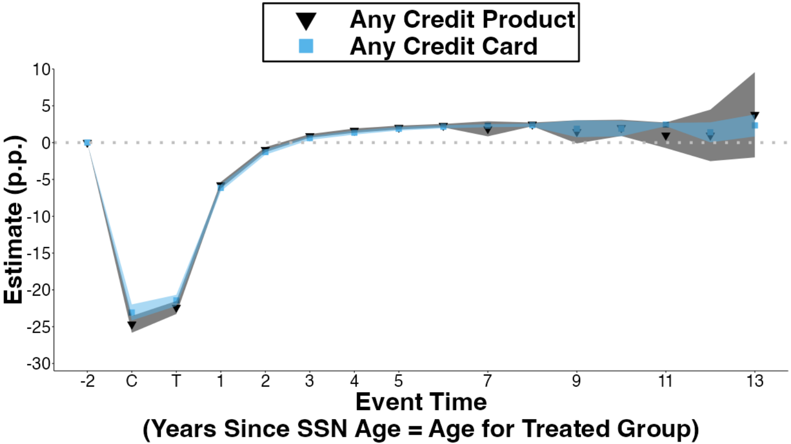


Credit Card Limits At Age 37, Conditional On Age 30 Credit Score

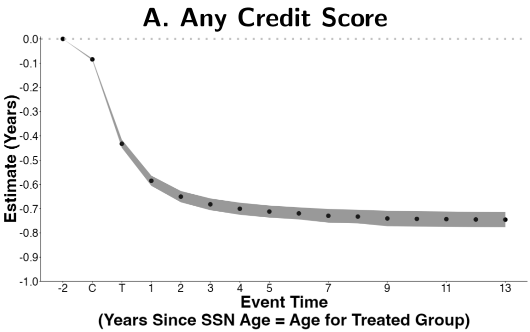


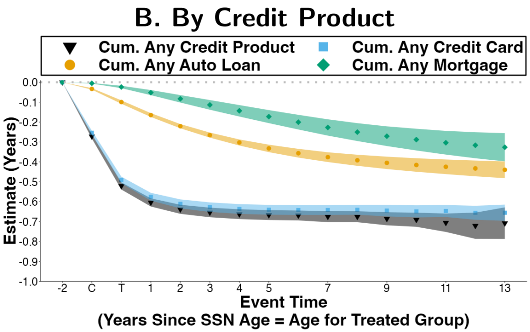


Paired Cohorts: First Credit Product & First Credit Card



Paired Cohorts: Cumulatives

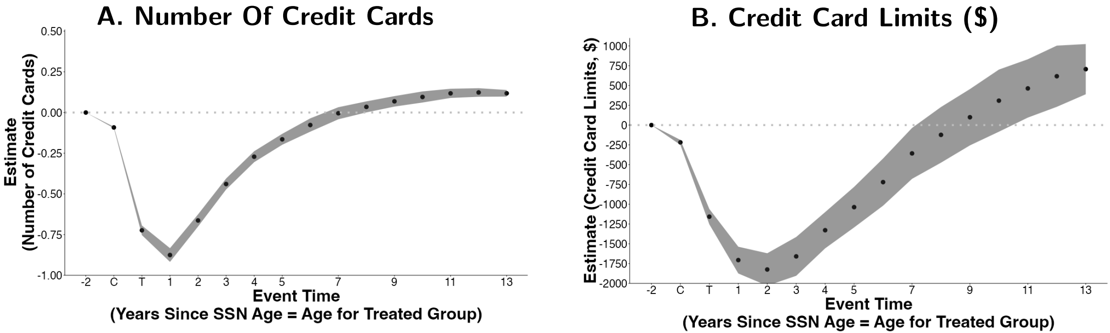




Paired Cohorts: Cumulative Years of Delay

	Any Credit Score	Credit Product	Auto Loan	Mortgage	Credit Card
Event Time	(1)	(2)	(3)	(4)	(5)
C	-0.085***	-0.272***	-0.033***	-0.005***	-0.253***
	(0.002)	(0.005)	(0.002)	(0.001)	(0.005)
T	-0.432***	-0.521***	-0.099***	-0.024***	-0.491***
	(0.009)	(0.009)	(0.004)	(0.003)	(0.008)
T+5	-0.712***	-0.667***	-0.332***	-0.173***	-0.640***
	(0.013)	(0.013)	(0.01)	(0.017)	(0.013)
T+10	-0.742***	-0.690***	-0.415***	-0.288***	-0.648***
	(0.016)	(0.018)	(0.017)	(0.028)	(0.016)
N Paired Cohorts	68	68	68	68	68
N Consumers	403,506	403,506	403,506	403,506	403,506
N	6,456,096	6,456,096	6,456,096	6,456,096	6,456,096

Paired Cohorts: Credit Cards



Potential Mechanism #2: Emigration

Proxy emigration by **attrition** from data

Immigrants exit data more than Non-Immigrants

- If arrive earlier, on average, exit data earlier, so can't explain paired cohort results

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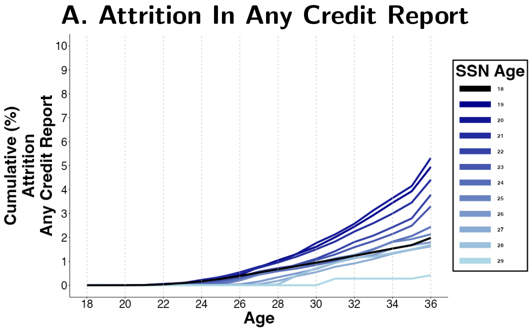
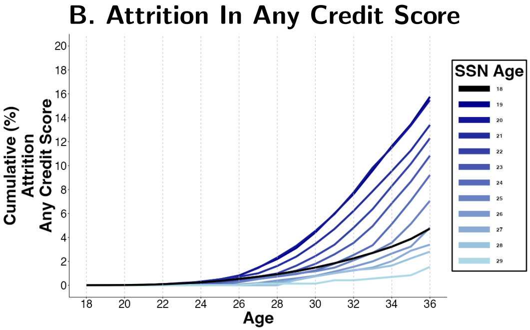
Restrict to consumers observed in 2024:

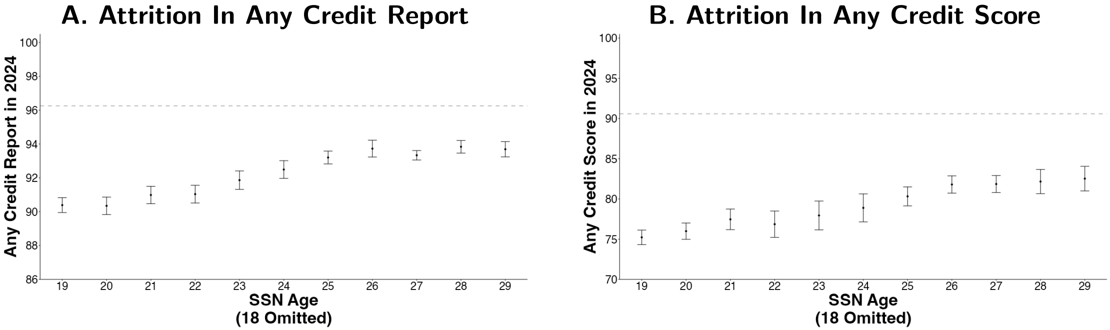
- **Mortgage** Immigrant vs. Non-Immigrant gap closes butSSN Age gap remains
- **Auto loan** Immigrant vs. Non-Immigrant gap & SSN Age gap remains
- **Credit card** dynamics by SSN Age remains

Attrition


A. Attrition In Any Credit Report
Cumulative (%) Attrition Any Credit Report
Age
SSN Age
18
19
20
21
22
23
24
25
26
27
28
29

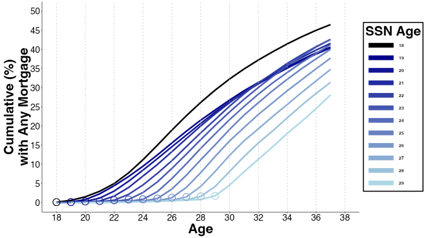

B. Attrition In Any Credit Score
Cumulative (%) Attrition Any Credit Score
Age
SSN Age
18
19
20
21
22
23
24
25
26
27
28
29

Consumers Observed In 2024

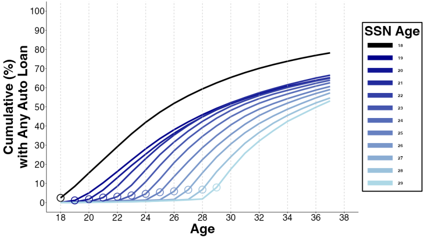


Lifecycle Of Credit For Consumers Observed In 2024

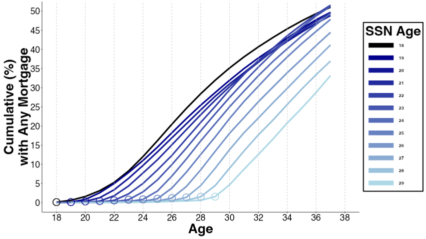
A. Mortgages (Any 2024 Report)



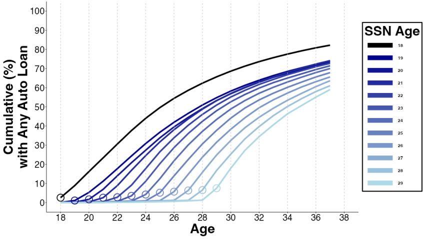
B. Auto Loan (Any 2024 Report)



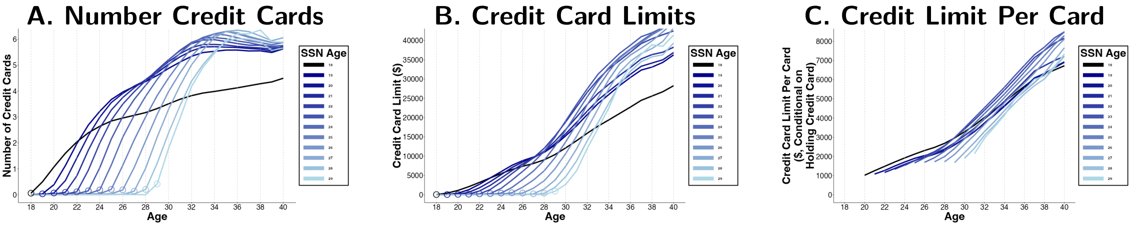
C. Mortgages (Any 2024 Product)



D. Auto Loan (Any 2024 Product)



Lifecycle Of Credit For Consumers Observed In 2024 (Any Tradeline)



Consumers Observed In Data In 2024 With Additional F.E.

Dep Var: In 2024, has...	Any Credit Report		Any Credit Score		Any Credit Tradeline	
	(1)	(2)	(3)	(4)	(5)	(6)
Immigrant	-2.64***	-4.85***	-7.52***	-12.16***	-7.50***	-12.07***
	(0.13)	(0.22)	(0.29)	(0.48)	(0.32)	(0.42)
SSN Age		0.52***		1.09***		1.08***
		(0.04)		(0.07)		(0.06)
F.E. Birth Year	X	X	X	X	X	X
F.E. First Zip5	X	X	X	X	X	X
F.E. Last Zip5	X	X	X	X	X	X
F.E. Longest Zip5	X	X	X	X	X	X
F.E. Number Zip5	X	X	X	X	X	X
R^2	0.034	0.034	0.110	0.111	0.138	0.138
N	6,122,932	6,122,932	6,122,932	6,122,932	6,122,932	6,122,932
Mean, SSN Age ¡21	96.15	96.15	90.31	90.31	85.03	85.03

Credit Access By Age 37 With Additional F.E. Conditional On Any Credit Score Observed in 2024

Dep Var: By Age 37, has...	Auto Loan		Mortgage		Credit Card	
	(1)	(2)	(3)	(4)	(5)	(6)
Immigrant	-8.30***	-2.01***	-2.89***	6.57***	1.03***	0.67***
	(0.81)	(0.22)	(0.71)	(0.41)	(0.20)	(0.13)
SSN Age		-1.46***		-2.20***		0.08
		(0.12)		(0.11)		(0.04)
F.E. Birth Year	X	X	X	X	X	X
F.E. First Zip5	X	X	X	X	X	X
F.E. Last Zip5	X	X	X	X	X	X
F.E. Longest Zip5	X	X	X	X	X	X
F.E. Number Zip5	X	X	X	X	X	X
R^2	0.099	0.099	0.134	0.134	0.054	0.054
N	5,489,726	5,489,726	5,489,726	5,489,726	5,489,726	5,489,726
Mean, SSN Age ¡21	80.37	80.37	48.76	48.76	96.05	96.05

Use Survey of Consumer Finances (SCF) 2022 To Evaluate Mechanisms

SCF 2022 includes if Immigrant & Age of Immigration

Adapt earlier cross-sectional regression to this data:

$$Y_i = \beta_1 \cdot \mathbb{I}\{\textit{Immigrant}\}_i + \beta_2 \cdot \textit{Immigration Age}_i + \mu_{b(i)} + \eta_{d(i)} + \epsilon_i$$

$\eta_{d(i)}$ are F.E. Demographic Controls: male, race, hispanic, spouse, male spouse, marital status, household size, number of children, education levels, & quintiles of household wage income

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$\eta_{d(i)}$ are F.E. Demographic Controls: male, race, hispanic, spouse, male spouse, marital status, household size, number of children, education levels, & quintiles of household wage income

SCF Debt Attitude Questions:

*"People have many different reasons for borrowing money which they pay back over a period of time. For each of the reasons I read, please tell me whether you feel it is all right for someone like yourself to borrow money...***to finance the purchase of a car***."*

Immigrants More Likely To Buy Cars With Cash (SCF, 2022)
12.5 p.p. [95% C.I. –2.2, 27.3], 17% Vs. Non-Immigrants

Dep Var:	Has Car		Any Auto Debt		Homeowner		Any Mortgage		Credit Card Limits	
	(1)	(2)	(3)	(4)	(5)	(6)	(7)	(8)	(9)	(10)
Immigrant	-7.13*	-6.14	-4.27	-11.14	-13.55***	0.35	-13.09***	-5.27	-3,078.8	6,373.8
	(3.15)	(4.96)	(5.08)	(8.27)	(4.64)	(6.85)	(4.64)	(7.22)	(3,460.2)	(6,316.0)
Immigration Age		-0.13		0.88		-1.78***		-1.00		-1,213.9*
		(0.47)		(0.76)		(0.59)		(0.64)		(582.4)
Demographic Controls	X	X	X	X	X	X	X	X	X	X
R^2	0.110	0.110	0.063	0.063	0.258	0.261	0.258	0.259	0.254	0.256
N	1,813	1,813	1,813	1,813	1,813	1,813	1,813	1,813	1,813	1,813
Mean, Immigration Age ¡21	89.23	89.23	47.14	47.14	53.98	53.98	45.25	45.25	$20,275.9	$20,275.9

*** 0.5%, ** 1%, * 5%, + 10% statistical significance

Immigrants Have ↓ Demand for Debt (↑ Auto, ↑ Credit Cards, ↑ Mortgage. All Attenuated By Immigration Age) To Non-Immigrants (SCF, 2022) ...But Low Statistical Power To Detect Out Differences

Dep Var: Apply For...	Any Credit		Auto		Mortgage		Credit Card		Other Credit	
	(1)	(2)	(3)	(4)	(5)	(6)	(7)	(8)	(9)	(10)
Immigrant	2.32	-1.08	2.03	-6.55	2.11	5.65	1.63	2.02	1.84	-7.66^{+}
	(4.56)	(7.17)	(4.37)	(7.53)	(3.8)	(6.85)	(3.22)	(5.32)	(3.62)	(4.61)
Immigration Age		0.44		1.10		-0.45		-0.05		1.22*
		(0.62)		(0.72)		(0.65)		(0.48)		(0.55)
Demographic Controls	X	X	X	X	X	X	X	X	X	X
R^2	0.051	0.051	0.051	0.053	0.045	0.045	0.045	0.045	0.026	0.029
N	1,813	1,813	1,813	1,813	1,813	1,813	1,813	1,813	1,813	1,813
Mean, Immigration Age ¡21	64.81	64.81	19.95	19.95	11.28	11.28	9.28	9.28	12.08	12.08

*** 0.5%, ** 1%, * 5%, $^{+}$ 10% statistical significance

Immigrants Have $\downarrow$ Demand for Debt ($\uparrow$ Auto, $\uparrow$ Credit Cards, $\uparrow$ Mortgage. All Attenuated By Immigration Age) To Non-Immigrants (SCF, 2022) ...But Low Statistical Power To Detect Out Differences

Dep Var: Apply For...	Any Credit		Auto		Mortgage		Credit Card		Other Credit	
	(1)	(2)	(3)	(4)	(5)	(6)	(7)	(8)	(9)	(10)
Immigrant	2.32	-1.08	2.03	-6.55	2.11	5.65	1.63	2.02	1.84	-7.66^{+}
	(4.56)	(7.17)	(4.37)	(7.53)	(3.8)	(6.85)	(3.22)	(5.32)	(3.62)	(4.61)
Immigration Age		0.44		1.10		-0.45		-0.05		1.22*
		(0.62)		(0.72)		(0.65)		(0.48)		(0.55)
Demographic Controls	X	X	X	X	X	X	X	X	X	X
R^2	0.051	0.051	0.051	0.053	0.045	0.045	0.045	0.045	0.026	0.029
N	1,813	1,813	1,813	1,813	1,813	1,813	1,813	1,813	1,813	1,813
Mean, Immigration Age ¡21	64.81	64.81	19.95	19.95	11.28	11.28	9.28	9.28	12.08	12.08

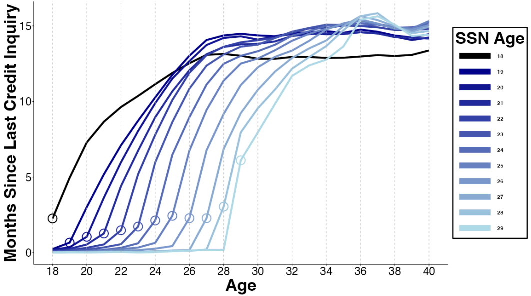
*** 0.5%, ** 1%, * 5%, $^{+}$ 10% statistical significance

Credit inquiries data in credit panel shows
$\uparrow$ immigrant credit demand in 20s, $\downarrow$ demand in 30s

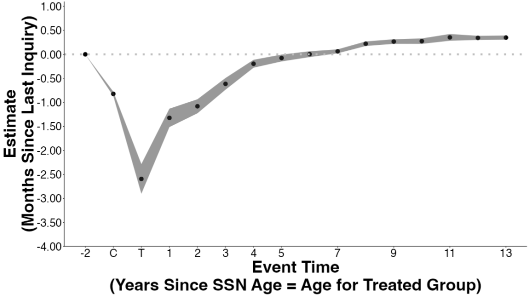
Does Lower Credit Demand Explain Lower Access?

Immigrants Have ↑ Credit Demand In 20s, ↓ Demand In 30s

A. Months Since Last Credit Inquiry
Higher Value = Lower Credit Demand



B. Paired Cohorts
Months Since Last Credit Inquiry



Caveat: Lower credit demand in 30s may be function of earlier rejections → deterrence

Inconclusive Evidence On Other Demand and Supply Proxies (SCF, 2022) ...Given Low Statistical Power To Detect Out Differences

	Why Did Not Apply For Credit?				Outcome After Applying For Credit?					
(Conditional On...	...Not Applying)				...Applying)		...Reject)		...Reject & Reapply)	
Dep Var:	No Demand		Rate Too High		Reject/Less		Reapply		Reapply Reject	
	(1)	(2)	(3)	(4)	(5)	(6)	(7)	(8)	(9)	(10)
Immigrant	0.41	6.84	8.01	-0.73	-4.95	-2.28	3.43	-10.42	46.10***	49.69**
	(7.98)	(12.64)	(5.85)	(8.25)	(4.74)	(7.43)	(14.11)	(22.95)	(14.27)	(18.81)
Immigration Age		-0.88		1.20		-0.33		1.73		-0.40
		(1.03)		(0.87)		(0.61)		(1.89)		(1.68)
Demographic Controls	X	X	X	X	X	X	X	X	X	X
R^2	0.155	0.155	0.090	0.092	0.054	0.054	0.063	0.062	0.312	0.307
N	666	666	666	666	1,147	1,147	292	292	178	178
Mean, Immigration Age ¡21	79.52	79.52	7.53	7.53	27.07	27.07	60.30	60.30	60.22	60.22

*** 0.5%, ** 1%, * 5%, + 10% statistical significance